COUNTER-EXAMPLES TO $\operatorname{Log} C_{3,2}$ IN CHARACTERISTIC 2 AND 3

SHO EJIRI

ABSTRACT. Let S be a quasi-hyperelliptic surface or a Raynaud surface of characteristic $p = 2$ or 3. Then there exists a separable surjective morphism $f : X \to S$ with connected fibers from a smooth projective 3-fold X to S and a smooth prime divisor B on X such that

$$\underbrace{\kappa\left(X, K_X + \frac{2}{p}B\right)}_{-\infty} < \underbrace{\kappa\left(X_\eta, K_{X_\eta} + \frac{2}{p}B\Big|_{X_\eta}\right)}_{0} + \underbrace{\kappa(S)}_{0 \text{ or } 1},$$

where X_η is the generic fiber of f.

1. Introduction

The following is a famous conjecture predicted by Iitaka [13].

Conjecture 1.1. *Let k be an algebraically closed field of characteristic 0. Let $f : X \to Y$ be an algebraic fiber space between smooth projective varieties with $\dim X = n$, $\dim Y = m$. Then,*

$$C_{n,m} : \kappa(X) \geq \kappa(X_\eta) + \kappa(Y),$$

where X_η is generic fiber of f.

Here, by algebraic fiber spaces we mean a separable surjective morphism with connected fibers. This conjecture has been studied by numerous mathematicians for half a century. For instance, see [21, 22, 23, 14, 24, 15, 16, 9, 2, 17, 10, 11, 12].

Conjecture 1.1 has been also studied in positive characteristic [4, 19, 5, 8, 1, 25, 3]. Recently, Cascini–Ejiri–Kollár–Zhang [3] constructed algebraic fiber spaces of positive characteristic that violate $C_{n,m}$. The smallest n in their work is 4 (when $p = 2$). In this note, we construct algebraic fiber spaces *with boundary divisors* that violate a natural generalization $\operatorname{Log} C_{3,2}$ of $C_{3,2}$ to the log case stated below.

Problem 1.2. *Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let (X, Δ) be projective lc pair of dimension n and let $f : X \to Y$ be an algebraic fiber space to a smooth projective variety Y of dimension m. Then does the following equation hold?*

$$\operatorname{Log} C_{n,m} : \kappa(X, K_X + \Delta) \geq \kappa(X_\eta, K_{X_\eta} + \Delta|_{X_\eta}) + \kappa(Y).$$

Theorem 1.3. *Let S be a quasi-hyperelliptic surface or a Raynaud surface of characteristic $p = 2$ or 3. Then there exists an algebraic fiber space $f : X \to S$ from a*

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* Primary 14J60, Secondary 14E99, 14F06.

smooth projective 3-fold X to S and a smooth prime divisor B on X such that

$$\underbrace{\kappa\left(X, K_X+\frac{2}{p}B\right)}_{-\infty} < \underbrace{\kappa\left(X_\eta, K_{X_\eta}+\frac{2}{p}B\Big|_{X_\eta}\right)}_{0} + \underbrace{\kappa(S)}_{0 \text{ or } 1}.$$

It is worth mentioning that if $p=3$, then $(X, \frac{2}{p}B)$ is klt.

Remark 1.4. The reason why there exist counter-examples to $\operatorname{Log} C_{n,m}$ may be a lack of a suitable assumption. For example, under the assumption that pairs induced on general fibers have only mild singularities, we have not found counter-examples of $\operatorname{Log} C_{n,m}$. Indeed, general fibers of algebraic fiber spaces in [3] have a cusp, and in Theorem 1.3, general fibers are isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}^1$ but the coefficient of the boundary restricted to general fibers is 2.

Remark 1.5. There are a couple of extensions of $C_{n,m}$ to the log case that allow boundaries on the base space, but we do not treat them in this note.

The purpose of this note is to prove Theorem 1.3. We also answer $\operatorname{Log} C_{2,1}$ affirmatively in positive characteristic.

Theorem 1.6. *Let k be an algebraically closed field of characteristic $p>0$. Let (S,Δ) be an lc projective pair of dimension 2 and let $f: S\to C$ be an algebraic fiber space to a smooth projective curve C. Then,*

$$\kappa(S, K_S+\Delta) \geq \kappa(S_\eta, K_{S_\eta}+\Delta|_{S_\eta})+\kappa(C). \tag{I}$$

Here, S_η is the generic fiber of f.

Declaration of AI assistance. The author used OpenAI's ChatGPT during the development of the example presented in this paper. In particular, ChatGPT was used to explore possible constructions and to assist with preliminary mathematical calculations. All mathematical statements and proofs presented in this paper have been independently verified by the author, who takes full responsibility for their correctness.

2. Counter-examples to $\operatorname{Log} C_{3,2}$

In this section, we construct counter-examples to the strong form of $\log C_{3,2}$. Let k be an algebraically closed field of characteristic $p=2$ or 3. We need to construct the Tango–Raynaud curve, but we refer it to [18, EXAMPLE 1.3].

Put $l:=5-p$. Let e, $C=Y$ and D be as in [18, EXAMPLE 1.3] with $l|e$. Take $\xi\in H^1(X,-D)\setminus\{0\}$ so that $F^*\xi=0$. Let

$$0\to\mathcal{O}_Y(-D)\to\mathcal{E}\to\mathcal{O}_Y\to 0$$

be the extension corresponding to ξ. Then, by $F^*\xi=0$, we find a subbundle $\mathcal{O}_Y\subset F^*\mathcal{E}$. Set $P:=\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{E})$ and let $g:P\to Y$ be the projection. Put $T:=c_1(\mathcal{O}_P(1))$. Let G' be the prime divisor on $\mathbb{P}(F^*\mathcal{E})$ corresponding to the subbundle $\mathcal{O}_Y\subset F^*\mathcal{E}$. Set $G:=F^*_{P/Y}G'$, where $F_{P/Y}$ is the relative Frobenius morphism of f. Then, by [18, PROPOSITION 1.7], we see that $\operatorname{Supp}(G)$ is smooth. Since $F\sim T+D$ and $G\sim pT$, we have

$$F+G\sim(p+1)T+D=l(rT+g^*D'),$$

so we can take an l-cyclic cover $\pi : S \to P$ brunched over $F + G$, where $r := \frac{p+1}{l}$ and $D' = \frac{1}{l}D$ (it is integral). This S is called Raynaud surface. Note that, if Y is a supersingular elliptic curve and $D = 0$, then S is a quasi-hyperelliptic surface. Also, we note that

$$K_P + \frac{2}{p}G \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} -2T + g^*(K_Y - D) + 2T \sim g^*(K_Y - D) \quad \text{and}$$
$$K_S \sim \pi^*(K_P + (l-1)(rT + g^*D')) \sim h^*(K_Y - D') = h^*((pl-1)D'),$$

where $h : S \to Y$ is the natural morphism. Therefore,

$$\kappa(S) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } D' = D = 0 \\ 1 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Note that $K_Y = pD = plD'$ be the construction of Y.

Put $X' := P \times_Y S$ and $B' := G \times_Y S \subset X'$. Then X' is smooth and B' is not smooth over the non-smooth locus of $h : S \to Y$. One can easily check that

$$K_{X'} + \frac{2}{p}B' \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} \sigma^*(K_Y - D - D'),$$

where $\sigma : X' \to Y$ is the natural morphism. Set $Z := \mathrm{Sing}(B')_{\mathrm{red}} \subset X'$. Let $\mu : X \to X'$ be the blow-up along Z, let B be the strict transform of B' and let E be the exceptional prime divisor of μ. We prove the following:

(1) X and B are smooth, and
(2) putting $c := \frac{p-4}{p} < 0$, we get

$$K_X + \frac{2}{p}B = \mu^*\left(K_{X'} + \frac{2}{p}B'\right) + cE.$$

If (2) holds, then we see that $\kappa\left(X, K_X + \frac{2}{p}B\right) < 0$, since $K_{X'} + \frac{2}{p}B'$ is $\mathbb{Q}$-linearly equivalent to the pull-back of a divisor on Y, $\mathrm{Supp}(E)$ dominates Y and $c < 0$. Since Z does not dominate S, we can easily check that $\kappa(X_\eta, K_{X_\eta} + 2/pB|_{X_\eta}) = 0$.

Let us show (1) and (2). The local equation of S over G can be written as

$$u^l = x^p - t,$$

where t is the parameter of Y. Let z be the parameter of P, and put $w = z - x$. Then the equation of pr_1^*G is

$$u^l + w^p = 0.$$

By an easy calculation, we see that B is smooth. Note that X' and Z are smooth by the construction, so X is smooth. Since B' has multiplicity 2 along Z, and the codimension of $Z \subset X'$ is 2, we obtain that

$$c = 2 - 1 - 2 \cdot \frac{2}{p} = \frac{p-4}{p}.$$

This completes the proof.

3. Proof of $\mathrm{Log}\, C_{2,1}$

In this section, we show Theorem 1.6.

Proof. For simplicity We denote $K_S + \Delta$ by K.

(1) We may assume at $\kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) \geq 0$ and $\kappa(C) \geq 0$.

(2) Suppose that $\kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) = 1$. Then $K|_{S_\eta}$ is ample. Taking a log resolution, we may assume that S is smooth. Put $\Delta_e := \frac{p^e}{p^+1}\Delta$ for $e \gg 0$. Then
- $\Delta_e \leq \Delta$,
- $K_{S_\eta} + \Delta_e|_{S_\eta}$ is ample and
- $K_S + \Delta_e$ is $\mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$-divisor.

Since $(S_\eta, \Delta|_{S_\eta})$ is F-pure, applying [7, Theorem 7.3], we get

$$\kappa(S, K) \geq \kappa(S, K_S + \Delta_e) \geq \kappa(S_\eta, K_{S_\eta} + \Delta|_{S_\eta}) + \kappa(C) = \kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) + \kappa(C).$$

(3) Let us consider the case when $\kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) = 0$. We use Tanaka's theorems on MMP for surfaces [20]. Firstly, taking a log resolution of (S, Δ) before running the MMP, we may assume that S is $\mathbb{Q}$-factorial. Write $\Delta = \Delta_h + \Delta_v$, where Δ_h and Δ_v are the horizontal part of Δ and the vertical part of Δ, respectively. Since $\kappa(S, K) \geq \kappa(S, K_S + \Delta_h)$, we may assume that $\Delta_v = 0$. Replacing S by its minimal model over C and applying the abundance theorem, we may assume that K is semi-ample over C. Since $\kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) = 0$, we see that $K \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} f^*L$ for some $\mathbb{Q}$-divisor L on C. To show inequality (I), it is enough to show that

$$\kappa(L) \geq \kappa(C).$$

(4) We consider the case when $\Delta_h = 0$. Let $\tilde{S}$ be a log resolution of S. Then applying [4, Theorem 1.3], we get

$$\kappa(S, K) \geq \kappa(S, K_S) \geq \kappa(\tilde{S}) \geq \kappa(\tilde{S}_\eta, K_{\tilde{S}_\eta}) + \kappa(C) = \kappa(S_\eta, K|_{S_\eta}) + \kappa(C).$$

(5) Next, we consider the case when $\Delta_h > 0$. We assume that $(S_\eta, \Delta|_{S_\eta})$ is klt. Let A be an effective ample divisor and take an $\varepsilon \in \mathbb{Q}$ with $0 < \varepsilon \ll 1$. Then $(S_\eta, (\Delta + \varepsilon A)|_{S_\eta})$ is F-pure and $K_{S_\eta} + (\Delta + \varepsilon A)|_{S_\eta}$ is ample, so we see from (2) that $\kappa(S, K + \varepsilon A) \geq 0$. Taking $\varepsilon \to 0$, we see that K is pseudo-effective. Therefore, we obtain that $\deg(L) \geq 0$.

(6) We treat the case where $(S_\eta, \Delta|_{S_\eta})$ is not klt but lc. Let D be a curve on S such that $\mathrm{coeff}_D(\Delta) = 1$. Since D dominates C, we have

$$0 \leq \deg K_C \leq \deg K_D = (K_S + D) \cdot D \leq K \cdot D = \deg((f^*L)|_D),$$

so $\deg(L) \geq 0$.

(7) If $\deg(L) > 0$, then $\kappa(L) = 1 \geq \kappa(C)$, so the proof completes. If $\deg(L) = 0$, then by the abundance theorem, we obtain $\kappa(L) = 0$. Therefore, our last goal is to show that $\kappa(C) = 0$ under the assumption that $K = K_S + \Delta \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} 0$. When $(S_\eta, \Delta|_{S_\eta})$ is not klt but lc, we see from the above inequality that $\deg K_C = 0$, so $\kappa(C) = 0$. Thus, we may assume that $(S_\eta, \Delta|_{S_\eta})$ is klt. Let D be a curve with $\delta := \mathrm{coeff}_D(\Delta_h) > 0$. Then

$$0 = K \cdot D = ((1 - \delta)K_S + \delta(K_S + D) + (\Delta - \delta D)) \cdot D \geq (1 - \delta)K_S \cdot D,$$

so $K_S \cdot D \leq 0$. Since $\deg(K_D) \geq 0$, by the adjunction, we get that $D^2 \geq 0$. From this, we see that Δ is nef (note that $\Delta = \Delta_h$). Thus,

$$-K_S = -K + \Delta \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} \Delta$$

is also nef. Then we obtain from [6, Theorem 4.1] that $-K_C$ is pseudo-effective, and hence $\kappa(C) = 0$. Note that [6, Theorem 4.1] requires that K_S is $\mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$-Cartier, but it is enough to show the pseudo-effectivity that K_{S_η} is $\mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$-Cartier (of course K_{S_η} is Cartier). Also, note that [6, Theorem 4.1] requires that the geometric generic fiber $S_{\overline{\eta}}$ is F-pure. Since $\Delta_h > 0$, we see that $-K_{S_\eta}$ is ample, which means that $S_{\overline{\eta}} \cong \mathbb{P}^1$, so we can apply the theorem.

□

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Email address: shoejiri.math@gmail.com